

gem-contribute

Building what you cannot find

Chris Hagmann · Blue Ridge Ruby 2026



Every Ruby developer has wanted to contribute back.
Most have never figured out where to start.

Building what you cannot find

I signed up to help organize **Hack Day** for this conference.

I needed a list of **good Ruby projects** to point people at.

That list didn't exist.



So I built one.

What's out there

- [goodfirstissue.dev](#) · opt-in registry · sparse
- [goodfirstissues.com](#) · opt-in registry · sparse
- [github.com/topics/good-first-issue](#) · opt-in topic · sparse
- [forgoodfirstissue.github.com](#) · curated · narrow

The inventories aren't sparse by accident — they're sparse because they're **opt-in**.

Drop opt-in and the inventory becomes **everything on GitHub**.

Now you need a **heuristic**.

bundle fund already chose

When you give *money* to open source, you don't pick a project at random. You pick from your **lockfile** — the projects you've already bet on, with versions pinned, code you have context on.

That's the same logic, whether the unit is **dollars** or **hours**.

gem-contribute is **bundle fund** **for time**.

The insight was already on disk

```
$ wc -l Gemfile.lock  
232 Gemfile.lock
```

Your `Gemfile.lock` is already curated.

- ~200 maintainers you've **already bet on**
- The OSS code you have **the most context on**
- A vote of confidence with versions attached

Start *there*, not on GitHub.

So I built it

```
$ gem-contribute scan
Scanning Gemfile.lock (232 gems)...
232 gems · 228 on github.com · 1 on gitlab.com · 3 unknown source

Top contributable projects (by open `good first issue` count):
  sorbet-runtime      50  github.com/sorbet/sorbet
  rspec-openapi       5   github.com/exoego/rspec-openapi
  packwerk            4   github.com/Shopify/packwerk
  rubocop             4   github.com/rubocop/rubocop
  ...
  gem-contribute      1   github.com/cdhagmann/gem-contribute
```

Drill in

```
$ gem-contribute issues rubocop
rubocop – 4 open "good first issue" issues

#14102 Allow Lint/Void to be configured per-method
https://github.com/rubocop/rubocop/issues/14102

#13871 Improve cop documentation for ...
https://github.com/rubocop/rubocop/issues/13871

...

To contribute: gem-contribute fix rubocop/<issue#>
```

Fix it

```
$ gem-contribute fix rubocop/14102
Forking rubocop/rubocop → cdhagmann/rubocop...
Cloning into ~/code/oss/rubocop/rubocop...
Forked, cloned, and branched.
  path:      ~/code/oss/rubocop/rubocop
  branch:    gem-contribute/issue-14102
  upstream:  github.com/rubocop/rubocop
  fork:      github.com/cdhagmann/rubocop
```

Next: `cd ~/code/oss/rubocop/rubocop` && make your changes,
then ``gem-contribute submit``.

Submit it

```
$ gem-contribute submit  
Pushing gem-contribute/issue-14102 to origin...  
Opened browser to:  
https://github.com/rubocop/rubocop/compare/cdhagmann:gem-contribute/issue-14102  
?expand=1&title=Fix+%2314102%3A+Allow+Lint%2FVoid+...&body=Closes+%2314102.
```

Browser opens. PR is pre-filled. Review. Click **Create**.

Audience demo

If you have a laptop:

```
gem install gem-contribute  
gem-contribute auth login  
gem-contribute fix gem-contribute/5
```

Edit `KICKED_THE_TIRES.yml`. Add yourself.

```
gem-contribute submit
```

I'll watch the auto-merge fire on screen behind me.

What's next

Now	Soon
CLI works end-to-end	Rooibos TUI (<code>gem-contribute</code> no args)
GitHub only	GitLab + others (host adapter pluggable)
Single canonical label	<code>preferred_labels</code> config
1 contributor on the world map	Many

```
gem install gem-contribute
```

Three good first issues open. Sandbox issue #5 always available.

Thanks

```
gem install gem-contribute
```

cdhagmann.com/gem-contribute

Built with substantial assistance from Claude (Anthropic).

Architecture and decisions are mine; a fair amount of the typing isn't.

Disclosed in the README; the ADRs are auditable independent of who or what produced the diff.